

The streets of Nightmarket are a battleground for competing shopkeepers and would-be fashionistas, and Lark Street—known for its many resellers and boutiques—is the most cutthroat street of them all.

HANNA FJORD (*greedy, conniving*), the proprietor of Hanna Fjord's Designer Boutique, hired you to break into **ELLISA HALLORAN'S** (*local, beloved, generous*) shop and steal the mock-ups for the new line of designs Ellisa is planning to unveil at the upcoming the 'Art on Lark' festival.

*"It's just business, dearies. Ellisa should know her place and stick to what she does best—selling sewing supplies. Steal those gowns and the jewelry; get rid of them. Throw them in the river, cut 'em up into ribbons, I don't care! Only **my** designs will be the star of the show!"*

APPROACH & OBSTACLES

APPROACH: The streetlamps outside Halloran's Haberdashery flicker and paint peels from the adjacent shops, one of which is boarded up. The haberdashery's recessed entrance is dark, as are the windows and the front-door. It looks like it's been closed for a number of days.

STREETSIDE: Though better days are in the past, Lark Street bustles with a flurry of shoppers and hawkers.

- ❖ Triple-bolted front-door
- ❖ A pair of Red Sashes guard the loading dock
- ❖ Broken second-floor windows face an alley

THE SHOP FLOOR: A guard dog sleeps between bolts of fabric and locked cabinets.

- ❖ Low-hanging oil lamps
- ❖ Crates of unsold bobbins, buttons, and cloth scraps
- ❖ A trapdoor hides a stash of magical implements
- ❖ Hastily made tripwires

THE DESIGN ROOM: Drawing tables and loose sketches fill the high-ceilinged back room.

- ❖ Ellisa's assistant, reading
- ❖ Mock-ups on mannequins
- ❖ Locked display cabinet of pattern books and grimoires
- ❖ Heavy curtains over the tall windows keeps the room dim

RUMORS: Ellisa Halloran died while working on her designs — Ellisa stole the designs herself
A Red Sash loan shark owns the shop's debt — Ellisa's assistant **ROSE** (*mute, gifted*) is a Dimmer Sister

SCENES & COMPLICATIONS

ROSE barely lifts her eyes from her book. You can hear her voice in your head. "You were fools to come here." Mannequins and dress forms lurch towards you, aggressively.

- ❖ A mannequin pins you to a sewing machine
- ❖ A bookcase crashes down on you
- ❖ The lamps go out; there's barely any light coming in through the curtain gaps

The guard dog blocks the way out and lets out a low growl when it sees the dresses. It wears an uncomfortable-looking spiked collar.

- ❖ The dog lunges and bites deep into your arm
- ❖ It shakes and its fur shimmers, releasing droplets of ectoplasm into the air
- ❖ When the collar is removed, the dog turns into an unconscious **ELLISA HALLORAN**

A crash somewhere outside. You hear voices calling to each other in Iruvian. It sounds like the Red Sashes are making a visit to check in on their investment.

- ❖ Raising suspicion; Red Sashes call for reinforcements (☹ 4)*
- ❖ A zealot hurls daggers in your direction
- ❖ You're tangled in a net with another player

Rose twirls a long pair of fabric scissors. "I won't let you interrupt me! Not when I'm so close to perfection. Now, hold still while I peel you out of those gowns... piece, by piece..."

- ❖ She throws handfuls of threaded needles at you. They're molten hot and tie you in place
- ❖ Rose snips off some of your fingers
- ❖ The fighting attracts a Bluecoat patrol (☹ 6)*

* Start a progress clock ☹ with four segments. For more information on clocks, check p. 15 of the Core Rulebook

FASHION IS DANGER: When touched or otherwise triggered, the gowns and jewelry suddenly spring to life, stuffing themselves onto you! They fit perfectly but won't come off. Beyond attaching themselves to intruders, these statement pieces are cursed with more attributes that will impede your escape.

DRESSED TO IMPRESS

Optionally, roll (or have players roll) on the tables below or come up with an appearance and a curse for each gown. Roll twice for appearance and combine choice details. Roll once for a curse.

APPEARANCE

CURSE

☐ black velvet – wispy blue silk – gold trim

☐ When you lie, take a Level 2 Harm “dazed”

☐ fabric wings – sheer drape – green veil

☐ The dress (*impatient, judgmental*) is talkative

☐ covered in writing – inlaid with red jewels

☐ Sequins chirp as you move your arms

☐ gossamer – heavy fabric – long skirts

☐ Everyone mistakes you for a famous Duke

☐ sleeveless – corset laces – slim tiara

☐ When you make eye-contact, you sneeze

☐ feathered gold mask – knee-high boots

☐ Animals follow you (e.g., rats, insects)

SIDING WITH ELLISA

Ellisa sighs heavily, partly with relief.

“I can spare some Coin for you, in thanks for getting me out of that predicament. I might have some work for you in the future, if you’re in the protection business.”

She goes on to explain that most of the dresses are her personal design, but she swears she had no hand in the curses.

SIDING WITH HANNA

“I’m very pleased. Take your payment. Hanna Fjord will be the number one boutique stop after people see my designs at the festival!”

Hanna pays you, then shows you her own designs. They don't look nearly as evocative as those you saw at Halloran's Haberdashery, but you have a feeling these are also less cursed. That being said, you don't feel any desire to put one on.